The Magic of Thinking Big

By David J. Schwartz

Success is determined not so much by the size of one's brain as it is by the size of one's thinking. History proves that the size of bank accounts, the size of happiness accounts, and the size of one's general satisfaction account is dependent on the size of one's thinking.

There is magic in thinking big.

"If Thinking Big accomplishes so much, why doesn't everyone think that way?"

All of us, more than we recognize, are products of the thinking around us. And much of this thinking is little, not big. All around you is an environment that is trying to tug you, trying to pull you down Second Class Street. You are told almost daily that there are "too many chiefs and not enough Indians." In other words, that opportunities to lead no longer exist, that there is a surplus of chiefs, so be content to be a little guy. This environment says other things too. It tells you; "Whatever will be will be," that your destiny is outside your control, that "fate" is in complete control. So forget those dreams, forget that finer home, forget that special college for the children, forget the better life. Be·resigned. Lie down and wait to die.

The basic principles and concepts supporting The Magic of Thinking Big come from the highest-pedigree sources, the very finest and biggest-thinking minds yet to live on planet Earth. Minds like the prophet David, who wrote, “one thinketh in his heart, so is he"; minds such as Emerson, who said, "Great men are those who see that thoughts rule the world"; minds like Milton, who in Paradise Lost wrote, "The mind is its own place and in itself can make a heaven of hell or a hell of heaven."

Think Big and you'll live big. You'll live big in happiness. You'll live big in accomplishment. Big·in income. Big in friends. Big in respect.

1 Believe You Can Succeed and You Will

SUCCESS MEANS MANY WONDERFUL, positive things. Success means personal prosperity: a fine home, vacations, travel, new things, financial security, giving your children maximum advantages. Success means winning admiration, leadership, being looked up to by people in your business and social life. Success means freedom: freedom from worries, fears, frustrations, and failure. Success means self-respect, continually finding more real happiness and satisfaction from life, being able to do more for those who depend on you.

Success means winning. Success~achievement~is the goal of life!

People confuse belief with wishful thinking. And true enough, you can't wish away a mountain.

You can't wish yourself into an executive suite. Nor can you wish yourself into a five-bedroom, three-bath house or the high-income brackets. You can't wish yourself into a position of leadership. But you can move a mountain with belief. You can win success by believing you can succeed. There is nothing magical or mystical about the power of belief.

Belief works this way. Belief, the 'I'm-positive-I-can" attitude, generates the power, skill, and energy needed to do. When you believe I-can-do-it, the how-to-do-it develops. A small number of young people really believe they will succeed. They approach their work with the 'I’m-going-to the-top" attitude. And with substantial belief they reach the top. Belief in great results is the driving force, the power behind all great books, plays, scientific discoveries. Belief in success is behind every successful business, church, and political organization. Belief in success is the one basic, absolutely essential ingredient of successful people. Believe, really believe, you can succeed, and you will.

Disbelief is negative power. When the mind disbelieves or doubts, the mind attracts "reasons" to support the disbelief. Doubt, disbelief, the subconscious will to fail, the not really wanting to succeed, is responsible for most failures.

Think, doubt and fail.

Think of victory and succeed.

Look at it this way. Belief is the thermostat that regulates what we accomplish in life. Study the fellow who is shuffling down there in mediocrity. He believes he is worth little, so he receives little. He believes he can't do big things, and he doesn't. He believes he is unimportant, so everything he does has an unimportant mark. As times goes by, lack of belief in himself shows through in the way the fellow talks, walks, acts. Unless he readjusts his thermostat forward, he shrinks, grows smaller and smaller, in his own estimation. And, since others see in us what we see in ourselves, he grows smaller in the estimation of the people around him.

Now look across the way at the person who is advancing forward. He believes he is worth much, and he receives much.He believes he can handle big, difficult assignments and he does. Everything he does, the way he handles himself with people, his character, his thoughts, his viewpoints, all say, "Here is a professional. He is an important person." A person is a product of his own thoughts. Believe Big. Adjust your thermostat forward. Believe big and grow big.

Take a stationery and write down the names of five people you've known well for several years who have far surpassed you in earning power and job responsibility. Ask yourself, what do my five friends have that I don't have, besides better jobs?

Your mind is a "thought factory." It's a busy factory, producing countless thoughts in one day.

Production in your thought factory is under the charge of two foreman, one of whom we will call Mr. Triumph and the other Mr. Defeat. Mr. Triumph is in charge of manufacturing positive thoughts. He specializes in producing reasons why you can, why you're qualified, why you will.

The other foreman, Mr. Defeat, produces negative, deprecating thoughts. He is your expert in developing reasons why you can't, why you're weak, why you're inadequate. His specialty is the "why-you-will-fail" chain of thoughts.

Both Mr. Triumph and Mr. Defeat are intensely obedient. They snap to attention immediately. All you need to do to signal either foreman is to give the slightest mental beck and call. If the signal is positive, Mr. Triumph will step forward and go to work.Likewise, a negative signal brings Mr. Defeat forward. Now; the more work you give either of these two foreman, the stronger he becomes.

Here is the first step toward success. It's a basic step. It can't be avoided.

Step One: Believe in yourself, believe you can succeed.

How to Develop the Power of Belief

Here are the three guides to acquiring and strengthening the power of belief:

1. Think of success, don't think of failure. At work, in your home, substitute success thinking for failure thinking. When you face a diffIcult situation, think, "I'll win," not 'I'll probably lose." When you compete with someone else, think, "I'm equal to the best," not "I'm outclassed." When opportunity appears, think "I can do it," never "I can't." Let the master thought "I will succeed" dominate your thinking process. Thinking about success conditions your mind to create plans that produce success. Thinking failure does the exact opposite. Failure thinking conditions the mind to think other thoughts that produce failure.

2. Remind yourself regularly that you are better than you think you are. Successful people are not supermen. Success does not require a superintellect. Nor is there anything mystical about success. And success isn't based on luck. Successful people are just ordinary folks who have developed belief in themselves and what they do. Never-yes, never-sell yourself short.

3. Believe Big. The size of your success is determined by the size of your belief. Think of little goals and expect little achievements. Think big goals and win big success.

2 Cure Yourself of Excusitis the Failure Disease

Things You Can Do About It

1. Refuse to talk about your health. The more you talk about an ailment, even the common cold, the worse it seems to get. Talking about bad health is like putting fertilizer on weeds. Besides, talking about your health is a bad habit. It bores people. It makes one appear self-centered and old-maidish. Success-minded people defeat the natural tendency to talk about their "bad" health. One may (and let me emphasize the word may) get a little sympathy, but one doesn't get respect and loyalty by being a chronic complainer.

2. Refuse to worry about your health.

3. Be genuinely grateful that your health is as good as it is.

4. Remind yourself often, "It's better to wear out than rust out." Life is yours to enjoy. Don't waste it. Don't pass up living by thinking yourself into a hospital bed.

5. Never underestimate your own intelligence, and never overestimate the intelligence of others. Don't sell yourself short. Concentrate on your assets. Discover your superior talents. Remember, it's not how many brains you've got that matters. Rather, it's how you use your brains that counts. Manage your brains instead of worrying about how much IQ you've got.

6. Remind yourself several times daily, "My attitudes are more important than my intelligence." At work and at home practice positive attitudes. See the reasons why you can do it, not the reasons why you can't. Develop an "I'm winning" attitude. Put your intelligence to creative positive use. Use it to find ways to win, not to prove you will lose.

7. Remember that the ability to think is of much greater value than the ability to memorize facts. Use your mind to create and develop ideas, to find new and better ways, to do things. Ask yourself, 'Am I using my mental ability to make history, or am I using it merely to record history made by others?"

8. Look at your present age positively. Think, "I am still young," not 'I am already old." Practice looking forward· to new horizons and gain the enthusiasm and the fee! of youth.

9. Invest future time in doing what you really want to do. It's too late only when you let your mind go negative and think it's too late. Stop thinking "I should have started years ago." That's failure thinking. Instead think, 'Tm going to start now, my best years are ahead of me." That's the way successful people think.

10. Accept the law of cause and effect. Take a second look at what appears to be someone's "good luck." You'll find that not luck but preparation, planning, and success-producing thinking preceded his good fortune. Take a second look at what appears to be someone's 'bad luck." Look, and you'll discover certain specific reasons. Mr. Success receives a setback; he learns and profits, But when Mr. Mediocre loses, he fails to learn.

11. Don't be a wishful thinker. Don't waste your mental muscles dreaming of an effortless way to win success. We don't become successful simply through luck. Success comes from doing those things and mastering those principles that produce success. Don't count on luck for promotions, victories, the good things in life. Luck simply isn't designed to deliver these good things. Instead, just concentrate on developing those qualities in yourself that will make you a winner.

3 Build Confidence and Destroy Fear

FRIENDS MEAN WELL WHEN they say, "It's only your imagination. Don't worry. There's nothing to be afraid of." But you and I know this kind of fear medicine never really works. Such soothing remarks may give us fear relief for a few minutes or maybe even a few hours. But the "it's-only-in-your-imagination" treatment doesn't really build confidence and cure fear. Yes, fear is real. And we must recognize it exists before we can conquer it.

Most fear today is psychological. Worry, tension, embarrassment, panic all stem from mismanaged, negative imagination. But simply knowing the breeding ground of fear doesn't cure fear. If a physician discovers you have an infection in some part of your body, he doesn't stop there. He proceeds with treatment to cure the infection. The old "it's-only-in-your-mind" treatment presumes fear doesn't really exist. But it does. Fear is real. Fear is success enemy number one. Fear stops people from capitalizing on opportunity; fear wears down physical vitality; fear actually makes people sick, causes organic difficulties, shortens life; fear closes your mouth when you want to speak.

Fear-uncertainty, lack of confidence--explains why we still have economic recessions. Fear explains why millions of people accomplish little and enjoy little. Truly, fear is a powerful force. In one way or another fear prevents people from getting what they want from life. Fear of all kinds and sizes is a form of psychological infection. We can cure a mental infection the same way we cure a body infection-with specific, proven treatments. First, though, as part of your pre treatment preparation, condition yourself with this fact: all confidence is acquired, developed. No one is born with confidence. Those people you know who radiate confidence, who have conquered worry, who are at ease everywhere and all the time, acquired their confidence, every bit of it. You can, too.

Action cures fear. Indecision, postponement, on the other hand, fertilize fear.

When we face tough problems, we stay mired in them. the mud until we take action. Hope is a start. But hope needs action to win victories. Put the action principle to work. Next time you experience a big fear or little fear, steady yourself. Then search for an answer to this question:

What kind of action can I take to conquer my fear?

Isolate your fear. Then take appropriate action.

Below are some examples of fear and some possible action cures.

TYPE OF FEAR	ACTION
1. Embarrassment because of personal appearance.	Improve it. Go to a barbershop or beauty salon. Shine your shoes. Get your clothes cleaned and pressed. In general, practice better grooming. It doesn't always take *new* clothes.
2. Fear of losing an important customer.	Work doubly hard to give better service. Correct anything that may have caused customers to lose confidence in you.
3. Fear of failing an examination.	Convert worry time into study time.
4. Fear of things totally beyond your control.	Turn your attention to helping to relieve the fear of others. Pray.
5. Fear of being physically hurt by something you can't control, such as a tornado or an airplane out of control.	Switch your attention to something totally different. Go out into your yard and pull up weeds. Play with your children. Go to a movie.
6. Fear of what other people may think and say.	Make sure that what you plan to do is right. Then do it. No one ever does anything worthwhile for which he is not criticized.
7. Fear of making an investment or purchasing a home.	Analyze all factors. Then be decisive. Make a decision and stick with it. Trust your own judgment.
8. Fear of people.	Put them in proper perspective. Remember, the other person is just another human being pretty much like yourself

Use this two-step procedure to cure fear and win confidence:

1. Isolate your fear. Pin it down. Determine exactly what you are afraid of.

2. Then take action. There is some kind of action for any kind of fear.

And remember, hesitation only enlarges, magnifies the fear. Take action promptly. Be decisive.

Much lack of self-confidence can be traced directly to a mismanaged memory. Your brain is very much like a bank. Every day you make thought deposits in your "mind bank." These thought deposits grow and become your memory. When you settle down to think or when you face a problem, in effect you say to your memory bank, "What do I already know about this?" Your memory bank automatically answers and supplies you with bits of information relating to this situation that you deposited on previous occasions. Your memory; then, is the basic supplier of raw material for your new thought.

The teller in your memory bank is tremendously reliable. He never crosses you up. If you approach him and say; "Mr. Teller, let me withdraw some thoughts I deposited in the past proving I'm inferior to just about

everybody else," he'll say; "Certainly; sir. Recall how you failed two times previously when you tried this? Recall what your sixth-grade teacher told you about your inability to accomplish things ... Recall what you overheard some fellow workers saying about you ... Recall ... " And on and on Mr. Teller goes, digging out of your brain thought after thought that proves you are inadequate.

But suppose you visit your memory teller with this request: "Mr. Teller, I face a difficult decision. Can you supply me with any thoughts which will give me reassurance?" And again Mr. Teller says, "Certainly, sir," but this time he delivers thoughts you deposited earlier that say you can succeed. "Recall the excellent job you did in a similar situation before .... Recall how much confidence Mr. Smith placed in you .... Recall what your good friends said about you .... Recall ... " Mr. Teller, perfectly responsive, lets you withdraw the thought deposits you want to withdraw. After all; it is your bank.

Here are two specific things to do to build confidence through efficient management of your memory bank.

1. Deposit only positive thoughts in your memory bank. Let's face it squarely: everyone encounters plenty of unpleasant, embarrassing, and discouraging situations. But unsuccessful and successful people deal with these situations in directly opposite ways. Unsuccessful people take them to heart, so to speak. They dwell on the unpleasant situations, thereby giving them a good start in their memory. They don't take their minds away from them. At night the unpleasant situation is the last thing they think about. Confident, successful people, on the other hand, "don't give it another thought." Successful people specialize in putting positive thoughts into their memory bank. Negative thoughts produce needless wear and tear on your mental motor. They create worry, frustration, and feelings of. inferiority. They put you beside the road while others drive ahead. Moments when you're alone with your thoughts-when you're driving, recall pleasant, positive experiences. Put good thoughts in your memory bank. This boosts confIdence. Just before you go to sleep, deposit good thoughts in your memory bank. Count your blessings. Recall the many good things you have to be thankful for: your wife or husband, your children, your friends, your health. Recall the good things you saw people do today. Recall your little victories and accomplishments. Go over the reasons why you are glad to be alive.

2. Withdraw only positive thoughts from your memory bank. "A person can make a mental monster out of almost any unpleasant happening," A job failure, a jilted romance, a bad investment, disappointment in the behavior of a teenage child-these are common monsters.

It is clear that any negative thought, if fertilized with repeated recall, can develop into a real mind monster, breaking down confidence and paving the way to serious psychological difficulties. Whether the psychological problem is big or little, the cure comes when one learns to quit drawing negatives from one's memory bank and withdraws positives instead.

Why do people fear other people? Why do many folks feel self-conscious around others? What's behind shyness? What can we do about it?

Here are two ways to put people in proper perspective:

1. Get a balanced view of the other fellow. Keep these two points in mind when dealing with people: first, the other fellow is important. Emphatically, he is important. Every human being is. But remember this, also: You are important, too. So when you meet another person, make it a policy to think, "We're just two important people sitting down to discuss something of mutual interest and benefit." The other fellow might look frightfully big, frightfully important. But remember, he is still a human being with essentially the same interests, desires, and problems as you.

2. Develop an understanding attitude. People who want figuratively to bite you, growl at you, pick on you, and otherwise chop you down are not rare. If you're not prepared for people like that, they can punch big holes in your confidence and make you feel completely defeated. You need a defense against the adult bully, the fellow who likes to throw his meager weight around.

Do what's right and keep your confidence. That's thinking yourself to success. Here is a psychological principle that is worth reading over twenty-five times. Read it until it absolutely saturates you:

To think Confidently, act confidently.

So, to think confidently, act confidently. Act the way you want to feel. Below are five confidence-building exercises, Read these guides carefully. Then make a conscious effort to practice them and build your confidence.

1. Be a front seater. Ever notice in meetings-in church, classrooms, and other kinds of assemblies-how the back seats fill up first? Most folks scramble to sit in the back rows so they won't be "too conspicuous." And the reason they are afraid to be conspicuous is that they lack confidence. Sitting up front builds confidence. Practice it. From now on make it a rule to sit as close to the front as you can. Sure, you may be a little more conspicuous in the front, but remember, there is nothing inconspicuous about success.

2. Practice making eye contact. How a person uses his eyes tells us a lot about him. Instinctively, you ask yourself questions about the fellow who doesn't look you in the eye. "What's he trying to hide? What's he afraid of? Is he trying to put something over on me? Is he holding something back?" Usually, failure to make eye contact says one of two things.

It may say, "I feel weak 'beside you. I feel inferior to you. I'm afraid of you." Or avoiding another person's eyes may say, "I feel guilty. I've done something or I've thought something that I don't want you to know. I'm afraid if I let my eyes connect with yours, you'll see through me."

Make your eyes work for you. Aim them right at the other person's eyes. It not only gives you confidence, it wins you confidence, too.

3. Walk 25 percent faster. Psychologists link slovenly posture and sluggish walking to unpleasant attitudes towards oneself, work, and the people around us. But psychologists also tell us you can actually change your attitudes by changing your posture and speed of movement. Watch, and you discover that body action is the result of mind action. The extremely beaten people, the real down-and-outers, just shuffle and stumble along. They have zero self-confidence. Average people have the "average" walk. Their pace is "average." They have the look of "I really don't have very much pride in myself."

Then there's a third group. Persons in this group show superconfidence. They walk faster than the average. There seems to be a slight sprint in the way they walk. Their walk tells the world, 'I’ ve got someplace important to go, something important to do. Throw your shoulders back, lift up your head, move ahead just a little faster, and feel self-confidence grow. Just try and see.

4. Practice speaking up. The more you speak up, the more you add to your confidence, and the easier it is to speak up the next time. Speak up. It's a confidence-building vitamin. Try to be the icebreaker, the first one in with a comment.And never worry about looking foolish. You won't.

5. Smile big. Most folks have heard at one time or another that a smile will give them a real boost. They've been told that a smile is excellent medicine for confidence deficiency. But lots of people still don't really believe this because they've never tried smiling when they feel fear.

Make this little test. Try to feel defeated and smile big at the same time. You can't. A big smile gives you confidence. A big smile beats fear; rolls away worry, defeats despondency.

4 How to Think Big

Ever ask yourself, "What is my greatest weakness?" . Probably the greatest human weakness is self-deprecation-that is, selling oneself short. Self Deprecation shows through in countless ways. Philosophers for thousands of years have issued good advice: Know thyself. But most people, it seems, interpret this suggestion to mean Know only thy negative self. Most self-evaluation consists of making long mental lists of one's faults, shortcomings, inadequacies, It's well to know our inabilities, for this shows us areas in which we can improve. But if we know only our negative characteristics, ·we are in a mess. Our value is small.

Here is an exercise to help you measure your true size.It works.

1. Determine your five chief assets. Invite some objective friend to help--possibly your wife, your superior, a professor, some intelligent person who will give you an honest opinion. (Examples of assets frequently listed are education, experience, technical skills, appearance, well-adjusted home life, attitudes, personality, initiative.)

2. Next, under each asset, write the names of three persons you know who have achieved large success but who do not have this asset to as great a degree as you.

When you've completed this exercise, you will find you outrank many successful people on at least one asset. There is only one conclusion you can honestly reach: You're bigger than you think. So fit your thinking to your true size. Think as big as you really are! Never, never, never sell yourself short!

Here is something very basic: We do not think in words and phrases. We think only in pictures and or images. Words are the raw materials of thought. When spoken or read, that amazing the instrument, the mind, automatically converts words and phrases into mind pictures. Each word, each. phrase, creates a slightly different mind picture.

Look at it this way. When you speak or write, you are, in a sense, a projector showing movies in the minds of others. And the pictures you create determine how you and others react. Suppose you tell a group of people, "I'm sorry to report we've failed." What do these people see? They see defeat and all the disappointment and grief the word "failed" conveys. Now suppose you said instead, '~Here's a new approach that I think will work." They would feel encouraged, ready to try again.

Suppose you say, "We face a problem." You have created a picture in the minds of others of something difficult, unpleasant to solve. Instead say, "We face a challenge," and you create a mind picture of fun, sport, something pleasant to do.

Or tell a group, "We incurred a big expense," and people see money spent that will never return. Indeed, this is unpleasant. Instead say, "We made a big investment," and people see a picture of something that will return profits later on, a very pleasant sight.

The point is this: Big thinkers are specialists in creating positive, forward-looking, optimistic pictures in their own minds and in the minds of others. To think big, we must use words and phrases that produce big, positive mental images.

The price tag the world puts on us is just about identical to the one we put on ourselves.

Here is how you can develop your power to see what can be, not just what is. I call these the "practice adding value" exercises.

1. Practice adding value to things. Ask yourself, "What can I do to 'add value' to

this room or this house or this business?" Look for ideas to make things worth more. A thing-whether it be a vacant lot, a house, or a business-has value in proportion to the ideas for using it.

2. Practice adding value to people. As you move higher and higher in the world of success, more and more of your job becomes "people development." Ask, "What can I do to 'add value' to my subordinates? What can I do to help them to become more effective?" Remember, to bring out the best in a person, you must first visualize his best.

3. Practice adding value to yourself. Conduct a daily interview with yourself. Ask, "What can I do to make myself more valuable today?" Visualize yourself not as you are but as you can be. Then specific ways for attaining your potential value will suggest themselves. Just try and see.

The 'i am doing my job and that's enough" attitude is small, negative thinking. Big thinkers see themselves as members of a team effort, as winning or losing with the team, not by themselves. They help in every way they can, even when there is no direct and immediate compensation or other rewards. The fellow who shrugs off a problem outside his own department with the comment "Well, that's no concern of mine, let them worry with it" hasn't got the attitude it takes for top leadership. Practice this. Practice being a big thinker. See the company's interest as identical with your own. Probably only a very few people working in large companies have a sincere, unselfish interest in their company. But after all, only a relatively few persons qualify as big thinkers. And these few are the ones eventually rewarded with the most responsible, best-paying jobs.

Practice these three procedures to help yourself think about trivialities:

1. Keep your eyes focused on the big objective. Many times we're like the salesman who, failing to make the sale, reports to his manager, "Yes, but I sure convinced the customer he was wrong." In selling, the big objective is winning sales, not arguments. In marriage the big objective is peace, happiness, tranquility not winning quarrels or saying "I could have told you so," In working with employees, the big objective is developing their full potential;not making issues out of their minor errors .

2. Ask "Is it really important?" Before becoming negatively excited, just ask yourself, "Is it important enough for me to get all worked up about?" There is no better way to avoid frustration over petty matters than to use this medicine.

3. Don't fall into the triviality trap. In milking speeches, solving problems, counseling employees, think of those things that really matter, things that make the difference. Don't become submerged under surface issues. Concentrate on important things.

5 How to Think and Dream Creatively

Believe it can be done. That's basic to creative thinking. Here are suggestions to help you develop creative power through belief:

1. Eliminate the word impossible from your thinking and speaking vocabularies. Impossible is a failure word. The thought "It's impossible': sets off a chain reaction of other thoughts to prove you're right.

2. 'Think of something special you've been wanting to do but felt,You couldn't. Now make a list of reasons why you can do it. Many of us whip and defeat our desires simply because we concentrate on why we can't when the only thing worthy of our mental concentration is why we can.

In business, in the home, in the community, the success combination is do what you do better (improve the quality of your output) and do more of what you do (increase the quantity of your output). Convinced it pays to do more and better? Then try this two-step procedure:

1. Eagerly accept the opportunity to do more. It's a compliment to be asked to take on a new responsibility. Accepting greater responsibility on the job makes you stand out and shows that you're more valuable. When your neighbors ask you to represent them on a civic matter, accept. It helps you to become a community leader.

2. Next, concentrate on "How can I do more?" Creative answers will come. Some -of these answers may be better planning and organization of your present work or taking intelligent shortcuts in your routine activities, or possibly dropping nonessential activities altogether. But, let me repeat, the solution for doing more will appear.

If you want it done, give it to a busy man. Refuse to work on important projects with people who have lots of free time. Fellow who has plenty of time makes an ineffective work partner. All the successful, competent people are busy. Progressive business management constantly asks, "What can we do to expand output?" Why not ask yourself, 'What can I do to expand my output?" Your mind will creatively show you how. The bigger the person, the more apt he is to encourage you to talk; the smaller the person, the more apt he is to preach to you.

Big people monopolize the listening.

Small people monopolize the talking.

Your ears are your intake valves. They feed your mind raw materials that can be converted into creative power. We learn nothing from telling. But there is no limit to what we can learn by asking and listening.

Try this three-stage program to strengthen your creativity through asking and listening:

1. Encourage others to talk. In personal conversation or in group meetings, draw out people with little urges, such as "Tell me about your experience ... " or "What do you think should be done about ... ?" or "What do you think is the key point)" Encourage others to talk, and you win a double-barreled victory: your mind soaks up raw material that you can use to produce creative thought, and you win friends. There is no surer way to get people to like you than to encourage them to talk to you.

2. Test your own views in the form of questions. Let other people help you smooth and polish your ideas. Use the what-do-you-think-of-this-suggestion? approach. Don't be dogmatic. Don't announce a fresh idea as if it were handed down on a gold tablet. Do a little informal research first. See how your associates react to it. If you do, chances are you'll end up with a better idea.

3. Concentrate on what the other person says. Listening is more than just keeping your own mouth shut. Listening means letting what's said penetrate your mind. So often people pretend to listen when they aren't listening at all. They're just waiting for the other person to pause so they can take over with the talking. Concentrate on what the other person says. Evaluate it. That's how you collect mind food.

6 You Are What You Think You Are

Look around you, You'll observe some people receiving the "Hey; Mac" or "Hey; buddy" treatment while others receive the sincere and important "Yes, sir" treatment, Watch, You'll observe that some people command confidence, loyalty, and admiration while others do not. Look closer still, and you'll also observe that those persons who command the most respect are also the most successful.

What is the explanation? It can be distilled into one word: thinking, Thinking does make it so. Others See in us what we see in ourselves, We receive the kind of treatment we think we deserve. Thinking does make it so, The fellow who thinks he is inferior, regardless of what his real qualifications may be, is inferior. For thinking regulates actions. If a man feels inferior, he acts that way, and no veneer of cover-up or bluff will hide this basic feeling for long. The person who feels he isn't important, isn't. On the other side, a fellow who really thinks he.is equal to the task, is.

To be important, we must think we are important, really think so; then others will think so too. Here again is the logic:

How you think determines how you act.

How you act in turn determines:

How others react to you.

Like other phases of your personal program for success, winning respect is fundamentally simple. To gain the respect of others, you must first think you deserve respect. And the more respect you have for yourself, the more respect others will have for you. Self-respect shows through in everything we do.

Let's focus our attention now on some of the specific ways we can increase self-respect and thereby earn more respect from others.

LOOK IMPORTANT-IT HELPS YOU THINK IMPORTANT - Remember, your appearance "talks." Be sure it says positive things about you. Never leave horne without feeling certain you look like the kind of person you want to be. Your appearance talks to you; but it also talks to others. It helps determine what others think of you. In theory, it's pleasant to hear that people should look at a man's intellect, not his clothes. But don't be misled. People do evaluate you on the basis of your appearance. Your appearance is the first basis for evaluation other people have. And first impressions last, out of all proportion to the time it takes to form them.

THINK YOUR WORK IS IMPORTANT - A friend who operates a personnel selection firm said this to me recently: "One thing we always look for in appraising a job applicant for a client is how the applicant thinks about his present job. We are always favorably impressed when we find that an applicant thinks his present job is important, even though there may be something about it he doesn't like. "Why? Simply this: If the applicant feels his present job is important, odds are that he will take pride in his next job, too. We've found an amazingly close correlation between a person's job respect and his job performance."

Here is some logic, sound, straight, and easy. Read it at least five times before you go on:

A person who thinks his job is important Receives mental signals on how to do his job better;

And a better job means More promotions, more money, more prestige, more happiness. The point is this: The way we think toward our jobs determines how our subordinates think toward their jobs.

Consider just one characteristic of successful people: enthusiasm. The basic step is simple: Think enthusiastically. Build in yourself an optimistic, progressive glow; a feeling that "this is great and I'm 100 percent for it." You are what you think. Think enthusiasm and you'll be enthusiastic. To get high-quality work, be enthusiastic about the job you want done. Others will catch the enthusiasm you generate and you'll get first-class performance.

Here are two suggestions for getting others to do more for you:

1. Always show positive attitudes toward your job so that your subordinates will "pick up" right thinking.

2. As you approach your job each day, ask yourself, 'Am I worthy in every respect of being imitated? Are all my habits such that I would be glad to see them in my subordinates?"

GIVE YOURSELF A PEP TALK SEVERAL TIMES DAILY

Practice uplifting self-praise. Don't practice belittling self-punishment. You are what you think you are. Think more of yourself and there is more of you. Build your own "sell-yourself-to-yourself" commercial. Every day you and I see half-alive people who are no longer sold on themselves. They lack self-respect for their most important product-themselves. These folks are indifferent. They feel small. They feel like nobodies; and because they feel that way, that's what they are. The half-alive person needs to be resold on himself. He needs to realize that he's a first-class person. He needs honest, sincere belief in himself.

Here's how to build your "sell-yourself to-yourself" commercial.

'First, select your assets, your points of superiority. Ask yourself, "What are my best qualities?" Don't be shy in describing yourself. Next, put these points down on paper in your own words. Write your commercial to you. Talk to yourself. Be very direct. Don't think of anyone but yourself as you say in your commercial. Third, practice your commercial out loud in private at least once a day. It helps a lot to do this before a mirror. Put your body into it. Repeat your commercial forcefully with determination. Make your blood travel faster through your body. Get yourself warmed up. Fourth, read your commercial silently several times every day. Read it before you tackle anything that demands courage. Read it every time you feel let down. Keep your commercial handy at all· times-then use it.

7 Manage Your Environment Go First Class

Environment shapes us, makes us think the way we do. Try to name just one habit or one mannerism you have that you did not pick up from other people. Relatively minor things, like the way we walk, cough, hold a cup; our preferences for music, literature, entertainment, clothing-all stem in very large part from the environment.

More important, the size of your thinking, your goals, your attitudes, your very personality is formed by your environment. Prolonged association with negative people makes us think negatively; close contact with petty individuals develops petty habits in us. On the bright side, companionship with people with big ideas raises the level of our thinking; close contact with ambitious people gives us ambition.

Experts agree that the person you are today, your personality, ambitions, present status in life, are largely the result of your psychological environment. And experts agree also that the person you will be one, five, ten, twenty years from now depends almost entirely on your future environment. You will change over the months and years. This we know. But how you will change depends on your future environment, the mind food you feed yourself.

Recondition Yourself for Success

Most people you know can be classified into three groups:

First group: Those who surrendered completely. The majority of people are convinced deep down inside that they haven't got what it takes, that real success, real accomplishment, is for others who are lucky or fortunate in some special respect. You can easily spot these people because they go to great lengths to rationalize their status and explain how "happy" they really are. Rationalizing yourself into a rut, which incidentally has been described as a grave with both ends open, can be as bad as wandering aimlessly, hoping opportunity will somehow; someday hit you in the face.

Second group: Those who surrendered partially. A second but much smaller group enters adult life with considerable hope for success. These people prepare themselves. They work. They plan.But, after a decade or so, resistance begins to build up, competition for top-level jobs looks rugged. This group then decides that greater success is not worth the effort. They rationalize, "We're earning more than the average and we live better than the average. Why should we knock ourselves out)". Actually, this group has developed a set of fears: fear of failure, fear of social disapproval, fear of insecurity, fear of losing what they already have. These people aren't satisfied because deep down they know they have surrendered. This group includes many talented, intelligent people who elect to crawl through life because they are afraid to stand up and run.

Third group: Those who never surrender. This group, maybe 2 or 3 percent of the total, doesn't let pessimism dictate, doesn't believe in surrendering to suppressive forces, doesn't believe in crawling. Instead, these people live and breathe success. This group is the happiest because it accomplishes the most. These people become top salesman, top executives, top leaders in their respective fields. These people find life stimulating, rewarding, worthwhile. These people look forward to each new day, each new encounter with other' people, as adventures to be lived fully.

Remember: People who tell you it cannot be done almost always are unsuccessful people, are strictly average or mediocre at best in terms of accomplishment. The opinions' of these people can be poisonous. Develop a defense against people who want to convince you that you can't do it. Accept negative advice only as a challenge to prove that you can do it. Be extra, extra cautious about trust: don't let negative-thinking people-"negators" --destroy your plan to think yourself to success. Negators are everywhere, and they seem to delight in sabotaging the positive progress of others.Make no mistake about it.

8 Make Your Attitudes Your Allies

Professor Erwin H. Schell, one of America's most respected authorities on leadership, says, "Obviously, there is something more than facilities and competence that makes for accomplishment. I have come to believe that this linkage factor, this catalyst, if you will, can be defined in a single word-attitude. When our attitude is right, our abilities reach a maximum of effectiveness and good results inevitably follow." Attitudes do make the difference. Salesmen with the right attitude beat their quotas; students with the right attitude make As; right attitudes pave the way to a really happy married life. Right attitudes make you effective in dealing with people, enabling you to develop as a leader. Right attitudes win for you in every situation.

Grow these three attitudes. Make them your allies in everything you do.

1. Grow the attitude that I'm activated.

2. Grow the attitude of You are important.

3. Grow the attitude of Service first.

A man who lacks enthusiasm never develops it in another. But a person who is enthusiastic

soon has enthusiastic followers. Dig into it deeper, and you'll develop enthusiasm. Put this principle to work next time you must do something you don't want to do. Put this principle to work next time you find yourself becoming bored. Just dig in deeper and you dig up interest.

In everything you do, life it up. Enthusiasm, or lack of it, shows through in everything you do and say. Life up your handshaking. When you shake hands, shake. Make your handclasp say, "I am glad to know you." "I am glad to see you again." A conservative, mouse-like handshake is worse than no handshake at all. It makes people think, "This guy is more dead than alive." Try to find a highly successful person with a conservative handshake. You'll have to look for a long, long time.

Life up your smiles.

Life up your thank yous.

Life up your talk. When you make a habit of coloring your words with sincere feelings you'll notice a great uptake in your ability to hold attention.

And when you put life in your talk, you automatically put more life in you. Just try this right now. Say out loud with force and vigor: "I feel great today!" Now, don't you actually feel better than you did before you said it? Make yourself alive all over.

Here's how to do it:

1. Practice appreciation. Make it a rule to let others know you appreciate what they do for you. Never, never let anyone feel he is taken for granted. Practice appreciation with a warm, sincere smile. A smile lets others know you notice them and feel kindly toward them. Practice appreciation by letting others know how you depend on them. Practice appreciation with honest, personalized compliments.

2. Practice calling people by their names. People like to be called by name. It gives everyone a boost to be addressed by name.

3. Don't hog glory, invest it instead. Pass praise on down to your subordinates, where it will encourage still greater performance. When you share praise, your subordinates know you sincerely appreciate their value.

Here's a daily exercise that pays off surprisingly well. Ask yourself every day, "What can I do today to make my wife and family happy?" Get the family on your team. Give them planned attention. In this busy age a lot of people never seem able to find time for their families. But if we plan, we can find it.

Want to Make Money Then Get the Put Service First Attitude

It's perfectly natural-in fact, it's highly desirable-to want to make money and accumulate wealth. Money is power to give your family and yourself the standard of living they deserve. Money is power to help the unfortunate. Money is one of the means to living life fully. The person who says he wants to be poor usually suffers from a guilt complex or a feeling of inadequacy. What's puzzling about money is the backward approach so many people use in trying to make it. Everywhere you see people with a "money-first" attitude. Yet these same people always have little money. Why? Simply this: People with a money-first attitude become so money conscious that they forget money can't be harvested unless they plant the seeds that grow the money.

And the seed of money is service. That's why "put service first" is an attitude that creates wealth. Put service first, and money takes care of itself.

Here is a simple but powerful rule that will help you to develop the put-service-first attitude: Always give people more than they expect to get. Each little extra something you do for others is a money seed. Volunteering to work late and get the department out of a tight spot is a money seed; giving customers extra service is a money seed because it brings customers back; advancing a new idea that will increase efficiency is a money ·seed. Money seeds, of course, grow money. Plant service and harvest money.

1. Grow the "I'm activated" attitude. Results come in proportion to the enthusiasm invested. Three things to do· to activate yourself are:

Dig into it deeper. When you find yourself uninterested in something, dig in and learn more about it. This sets off enthusiasm. Life up everything about you: your smile, your handshake, your talk, even your walk. Act alive. Broadcast good news. No' one ever accomplished anything positive telling bad news.

2. Grow the "You are important" attitude. People do more for you when you make them feel important. Remember to do these things:

Show appreciation at every opportunity.

Make people feel important.

Call people by name.

3. Grow the "Service first" attitude, and watch money take care of itself. Make it a rule in everything you do: give people more than they expect to get.

9 Think Right Toward People

HERE IS A BASIC rule for winning success. Let's mark it in the mind and remember it. The rule is: Success depends on the support of other people. The only hurdle between you and what you want to be is the support of others.

1. Learn to remember names. Inefficiency at this point may indicate that your interest is not sufficiently outgoing.

2. Be a comfortable person so there is no strain in being with you. Be an old-shoe kind of individual.

3. Acquire the quality of relaxed easy-going so that things do not ruffle you

4. Don't be egotistical. Guard against the impression that you know it all.

5. Cultivate the quality of being interesting so people will get something of value from their association with you.

6. Study to get the "scratchy" elements out of your personality, even those of which you may be unconscious.

7. Sincerely attempt to heal, on an honest basis, every misunderstanding you have had or now have. Drain off your grievances.

8. Practice liking people until you learn to do so genuinely.

9. Never miss an opportunity to say a word of congratulation upon anyone's achievement, or express sympathy in sorrow or disappointment.

10. Give spiritual strength to people, and they will give genuine affection to you.

Take the initiative in building friendships. Leaders always do. It's easy and natural for us to tell ourselves, "Let him make the first move." "Let them call us." "Let her speak first."

It's easy; too, virtually to ignore other people. Yes, it's easy and natural, but it isn't right thinking toward people. If you follow the rule of letting the other person build the foundation for friendship, you may not have many friends. Actually; it's a mark of real leadership to take the lead in getting to know people.

Think right toward people. As a friend of mIne expresses it, "I may not be very important to him, but he's important to me.That's why I've got to get to know him."

1. Recognize the fact that no person is perfect. Some people are more nearly perfect than others, but no man is absolutely perfect. The most human quality about human beings is that they make mistakes, all kinds of them.

2. Recognize the fact that the other fellow has a right to be different. Never play God about anything. Never dislike people because their habits are different from your own or because they prefer different clothes, religion, parties, or automobiles. You don't have to approve of what another fellow does, but you must not dislike him for doing it.

3. Don't be a reformer. Put a little more "live and let live" into your philosophy. Most people intensely dislike being told "you're wrong." You have a right to your own opinion, but sometimes it's better to keep it to yourself.

10 Get the Action Habit

Expect future obstacles and difficulties. Every venture presents risks, problems, and uncertainties. You can't eliminate all risks. Meet problems and obstacles as they arise. The test of a successful person is not the ability to eliminate all problems before he takes action, but rather the ability to find solutions to difficulties when he encounters them. Cross bridges when you come to them. We can't buy an insurance policy against all problems.

Give your ideas value by acting on them. Regardless of how good the idea is, unless you do something with it, you gain nothing. Second, act on your ideas and gain tranquility. A good idea if not acted upon produces terrible psychological pain. But a good idea acted upon brings enormous mental satisfaction.

Got a good idea? Then do something about it. Use action to cure fear and gain confidence. Here's something to remember. Action feeds and strengthens confidence; inaction in all forms feeds fear. To fight fear, act. To increase fear-wait, put off, postpone. Action cures fear.

Use the mechanical way to accomplish simple but sometimes unpleasant business and household chores. Rather than think about the unpleasant features of the task, jump right in and get going without a lot of deliberation. Tell yourself, 'I am in condition right now to begin. I can't gain anything by putting it off.

11 How to Turn Defeat into Victory

Have the courage to face your faults. Being self-critical is constructive. It helps you to build the personal strength and efficiency needed for success. Blaming others is destructive. You gain absolutely nothing from "proving" that someone else is wrong. Be constructively self-critical. Don't run away from inadequacies. Be like the real professionals. They seek out their faults and weaknesses, then correct them. That's what makes them professionals.

Tell yourself, "There IS a way." All thoughts are magnetic. As soon as you tell yourself, 'Tm beaten. There's no way to conquer this problem," negative thoughts are attracted, and each of these helps convince you that you are right, that you are whipped. Believe instead, "There is a way to solve this problem," and positive thoughts rush into your mind to help you find a solution.

It's believing there is a way that is important.

Five guideposts to help you turn defeat into victory are:

1. Study. setbacks to pave your way to success. When you lose, learn, and then go on to win next time.

2. Have the courage to be your own constructive critic. Seek out your faults and weaknesses and then correct them. This makes you a professional.

3. Stop blaming luck. Research each setback. Find out what went wrong. Remember, blaming luck never got anyone where he wanted to go.

4. Blend persistence with experimentation. Stay with your goal but don't beat your head against a stone wall. Try new approaches. Experiment.

12 Use Goals to Help You Grow

McKinsey Foundation for Management Research conducted a large-scale study to determine what it takes to become an executive. Leaders in business, government, science, and religion were questioned. Over and over again in different ways these researchers' kept getting one answer: the most important qualification for an executive is the sheer desire to get ahead.

"A man is not doing much until the cause he works for possesses all there is of him."

Desire, when harnessed, is power. Failure to follow desire, to do what you want to do most, paves the way to mediocrity. Success requires heart-and-soul effort, and you can put your heart and soul into something you really desire. When you surrender yourself to your desires, when you let yourself become obsessed with a goal, you receive the physical power, energy; and enthusiasm needed to accomplish your goal. But you receive' something else, something equally valuable. You receive the "automatic instrumentation" needed to keep you going straight to your objective. The most amazing thing about a deeply entrenched goal is that it

keeps you on course to reach your target. This isn't double-talk. What happens is this. When you surrender to your goal, the goal works itself into your subconscious mind. Your subconscious mind is always in balance. Your conscious mind is not, unless it is in tune with what your subconscious mind is thinking. Without full cooperation from the subconscious mind, a person is hesitant, confused, indecisive. Now, with your goal absorbed into your subconscious mind you react the right way automatically. The conscious mind is free for clear, straight thinking.

Now, as you press forward to success, set goals: deadlines, target dates, self-imposed quotas. You will accomplish only what you plan to accomplish. Goals, intense goals, can keep a person alive when nothing else will.

The step-by-step method is the only intelligent way to The person who wants freedom from the habit all at once fails because the psychological pain is more than he can stand. An hour is easy; forever is difficult. Winning any objective requires a step-by-step method.

Do this: Start marching toward your ultimate goal by making the next task you perform, regardless of how unimportant it may seem, a step in the right direction. Commit this question to memory and use it to evaluate everything you do: "Will this help take me where I want to go? If the answer is no, back off; if yes, press ahead .It's clear. We do not make one big jump to success. We get there one step at a time.

13 How to Think Like a Leader

What kind of world

would this world be,

If everyone in it

were just like me !

To add meaning to this self-imposed test, substitute the word company for world so it reads:

What kind of company

would this company be,

If everyone in it

were just like me !

In similar fashion, ask yourself what kind of club, community, school, church would it be If everyone in it acted like you. Think, talk, act, live the way you want your subordinates to think, talk, act, live-and they will. Over a period of time, subordinates tend to become carbon copies of their chief. The simplest way to get high-level performance is to be sure the master copy is worth duplicating.

Check the lives of the great religious leaders, and you'll find each of them spent considerable time alone.